

PARISHRAM 2027

THE RATTRAP

Lecture -10 Class 12

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TOPICS TO BE COVERED

ENGLISH LITERATURE

01

WARM-UP GAME

02

THE RATTRAP (Part - 01)

03

EXERCISE AND QUIZ



GAME TIME



What is the antonym of “optimistic”?

- A) Hopeful
- B) Cheerful
- ☒ C) Pessimistic
- D) Confident

What is the antonym of "mundane"?

↓
boring

- ✓ A) Extraordinary
- B) Boring
- C) Ordinary
- D) Common

The promotion was the icing on the cake after a year of hard work.

- A)** A disappointment after success
- B)** A failure to achieve something
- C)** An unexpected problem
- D)** An additional benefit





THE RATTRAP

By Selma Lagerlof



Introduction



- This story is set amidst the mines of Sweden, rich in iron ore.
- The story is about a poor wanderer who used to make his living by selling rattraps made out of begged material. He also took to petty stealing at times as selling rattraps alone was not enough.
- When lonely, a somber thought often crossed the rattrap-seller's mind. He felt that all the comforts of life were nothing, but baits set to trap human beings. Thus he found the world to be similar to a rattrap.



About The Author



- Selma Lagerlof (1858-1940) was a Swedish writer whose stories have been translated into many languages.
- A universal theme runs through all of them — a belief that the essential goodness in a human being can be awakened through understanding and love.
- She was the first woman to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, which she was awarded in 1909.
- Additionally, she was the first woman to be granted a membership in the Swedish Academy in 1914.



Once upon a time there was a man who
(travelled , घूमता)
went around selling small rattraps of
(free time , खाली)
wire. He made them himself at odd
moments, from the material he got by
begging in the stores or at the big farms.



But even so, the business was not

(take help , सहारा लेना)

especially profitable, so he had to resort

(small , छोटा) (stealing , चोरी)

to both begging and petty thievery to

(survive , जीवित रहना)

keep body and soul together. Even so, his

(torn clothes , फटे कपड़े)

clothes were in rags, his cheeks were

(hollow , धँसे हुए)

(shone , चमकी)

sunken, and hunger gleamed in his eyes.



No one can imagine how sad and
(boring, चमकी)
monotonous life can appear to such a
(wanderer, घुमक्कड़) (walks slowly, धीरे चलता)
vagabond, who plods along the road, left
(thoughts, विचार)
to his own meditations. But one day this
(idea, विचारधारा)
man had fallen into a line of thought,
which really seemed to him entertaining.



He had naturally been thinking of his
rattraps when suddenly he was struck by
(सूझा)
(around, आसपास)
the idea that the whole world about him
— the whole world with its lands and
seas, its cities and villages — was
nothing but a big rattrap.



It had never existed for any other
(lures , लालच)
purpose than to set baits for people. It
offered riches and joys, shelter and food,
heat and clothing, exactly as the rattrap
(pig meat , सूअर का मांस)
offered cheese and pork, and as soon as
(attracted , ललचाया)
anyone let himself be tempted to touch
the bait, it closed in on him, and then
everything came to an end.



The world had, of course, never been
very kind to him, so it gave him
(unusual, असामान्य) (badly, बुरा)
unwonted joy to think ill of it in this way.



(loved , प्रिय) (hobby , मनोरंजन)

It became a cherished pastime of his,

(dull , नीरस) (slow walks , थकी चाल)

during many dreary ploddings, to think

of people he knew who had let

themselves be caught in the dangerous

(trap , जाल)

snare, and of others who were still

(lure , लालच)

circling around the bait.



(walking tiredly , थककर चलना)

One dark evening as he was trudging.

along the road he caught sight of a little

(small house , कुटिया)

gray cottage by the roadside, and he

(protection , आश्रय)

knocked on the door to ask shelter for

(denied , मना किया)

the night. Nor was he refused.



(unfriendly , रूखा)

Instead of the sour faces which ordinarily met him, the owner, who was an old man without wife or child, was happy to get someone to talk to in his loneliness.



(soft cereal food , दलिया)

Immediately he put the porridge pot on

(evening meal , रात का खाना)

the fire and gave him supper; then he

(cut off , काटकर निकाला)

carved off such a big slice from his

tobacco roll that it was enough both for

the stranger's pipe and his own. Finally,

he got out an old pack of cards and

(card game , ताश का खेल)

played 'mjolis' with his guest until

bedtime.



(giving , उदार)

The old man was just as generous with
(secrets , निजी बातें)
his confidences as with his porridge and
tobacco.



The guest was informed at once that in his
 (**wealth** , **समृद्धि**)
 days of prosperity his host had been a
 (**small farmer** , **छोटा किसान**)
crofter at Ramsjo Ironworks and had
 worked on the land. Now that he was no
 longer able to do day labour, it was his cow
 (**cow** , **गाय**)
 which supported him. Yes, that bossy was
 extraordinary. She could give milk for the
 (**dairy** , **डेयरी**)
creamery every day, and last month he had
 (**a unit of currency**)
 received all of thirty kronor in payment.



Crofter- a person in Scotland who rents
or owns a small farm adjoining a house



The stranger must have seemed
(**doubtful** , अविश्वासी)
incredulous, for the old man got up and
went to the window, took down a leather
pouch which hung on a nail in the very
window frame, and picked out three
folded (**notes** , नोट)
wrinkled ten-kronor bills.



These he held up before the eyes of his
(**moving head** , **सिर हिलाना**)
guest, nodding knowingly, and then
(**pushed them in** , **ठूसकर रखा**)
stuffed them back into the pouch.



(**early time** , समय से / जल्दी)

The next day both men got up in good season. The crofter was in a hurry to milk his cow, and the other man probably thought he should not stay in bed when the head of the house had gotten up.



They left the cottage at the same time.
The crofter locked the door and put the
key in his pocket. The man with the
rattraps said good bye and thank you,
(then , उसके बाद)
and thereupon each went his own way.



But half an hour later the rattrap peddler stood again before the door. He did not try to get in, however



(broke , तोड़ दिया)

He only went up to the window, smashed
a pane, stuck in his hand, and got hold of
the pouch with the thirty kronor. He took
(pushed it , ठूस दिया)
the money and thrust it into his own
pocket. Then he hung the leather pouch
very carefully back in its place and went
away.



As he walked along with the money in
(happy , खुश)
his pocket, he felt quite pleased with his
smartness.



Q. Why was the peddler amused by the idea of the world being a rattrap?

- A) It gave him a sense of superiority over others.
- ✓ B) It reflected his own experiences with poverty and temptation.
- C) He thought it was a humorous way to see the world.
- D) It made him feel less lonely.

Q. Why was the crofter so talkative and friendly with the peddler?

- A) He was naturally talkative with everyone.
- ✓ B) He was lonely and happy to have someone to talk to.
- C) He wanted to show off his wealth.
- D) He was suspicious of the peddler and wanted to gather information.

Q. Why did the crofter show the thirty kronor to the peddler?

- ✓ A) To boast about his wealth
- B) To convince the peddler to stay longer
- C) To prove the productivity of his cow ✓
- D) To make the peddler feel jealous

(naturally , स्वाभाविक रूप से)

He realised, of course, that at first, he dared not continue on the public highway, but must turn off the road, into the woods. During the first hours this caused him no difficulty.



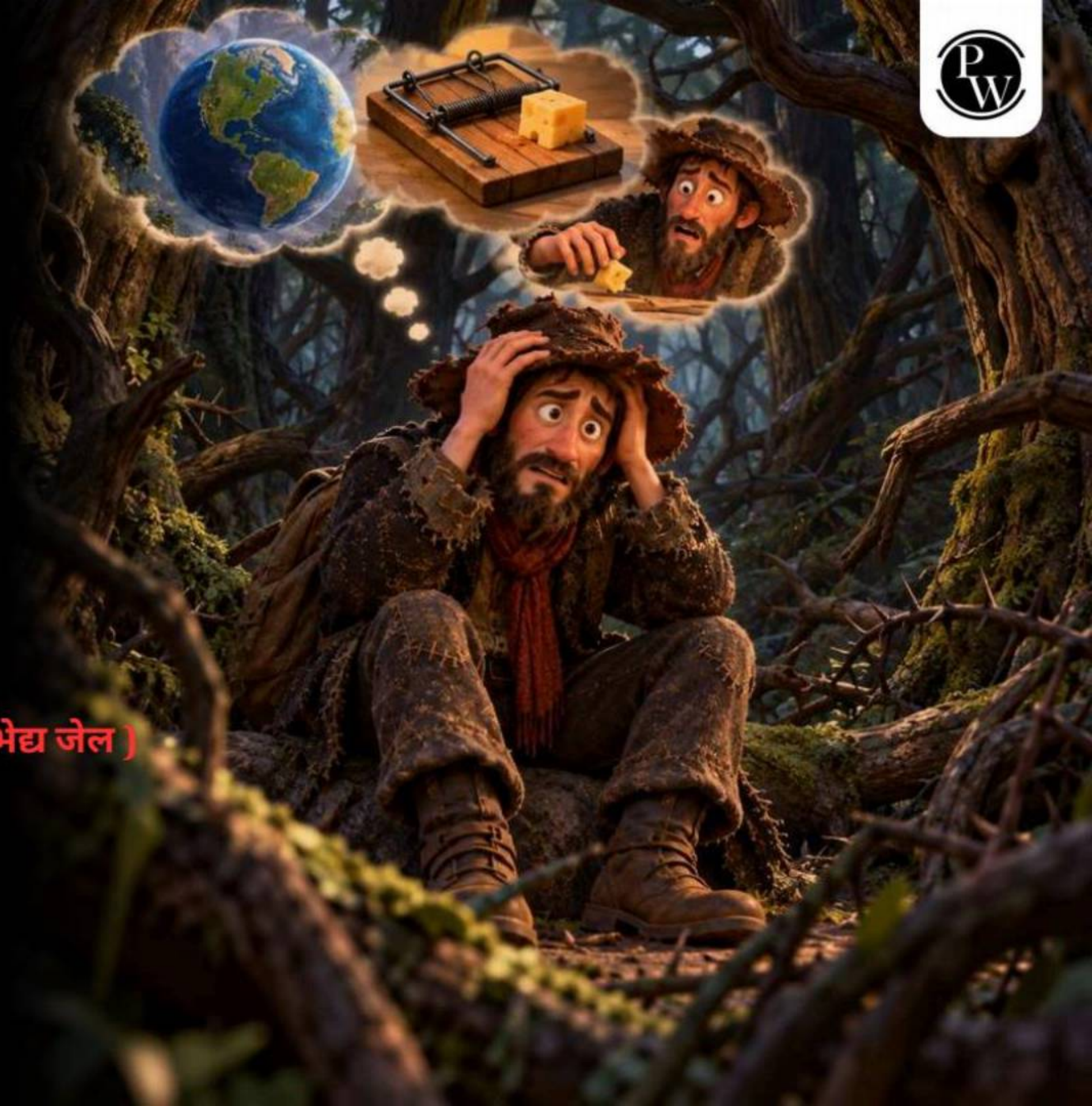
Later in the day it became worse, for it was a big and confusing forest which he had gotten into. He tried, to be sure, to walk in a definite direction, but the paths (**turned** , मुड़ते थे) twisted back and forth so strangely!



He walked and walked without coming
(forest , जंगल)
to the end of the wood, and finally he
realised that he had only been walking
around in the same part of the forest.



All at once he recalled his thoughts about the world and the rattrap. Now his own turn had come. He had let himself be (**deceived** , धोखा खाया) fooled by a bait and had been caught. The (**lure** , लालच) whole forest, with its trunks and (**tree stems and arms** , तने और शाखाएँ) branches, its thickets and fallen logs, (**inescapable prison** , अभेद्य जेल) closed in upon him like an impenetrable prison from which he could never escape.



It was late in December. Darkness was already descending over the forest. This increased the danger and increased also (**sadness** , उदासी) (**hopelessness** , निराशा) his *gloom* and *despair*. Finally, he saw no way out, and he (**collapsed** , गिर पड़ा) *sank down* on the ground, tired to death, thinking that his last moment had come.



But just as he laid his head on the ground, he heard a sound—a hard (**pounding sound** , धमक) regular thumping. There was no doubt as to what that was. He raised himself. (**hits** , प्रहार) “Those are the hammer strokes from an iron mill”, he thought. “There must be people nearby”.



(gathered , जुटाया)

He summoned all his strength, got up,

(walked unsteadily , लड़खड़ाकर चला)

and staggered in the direction of the

sound.



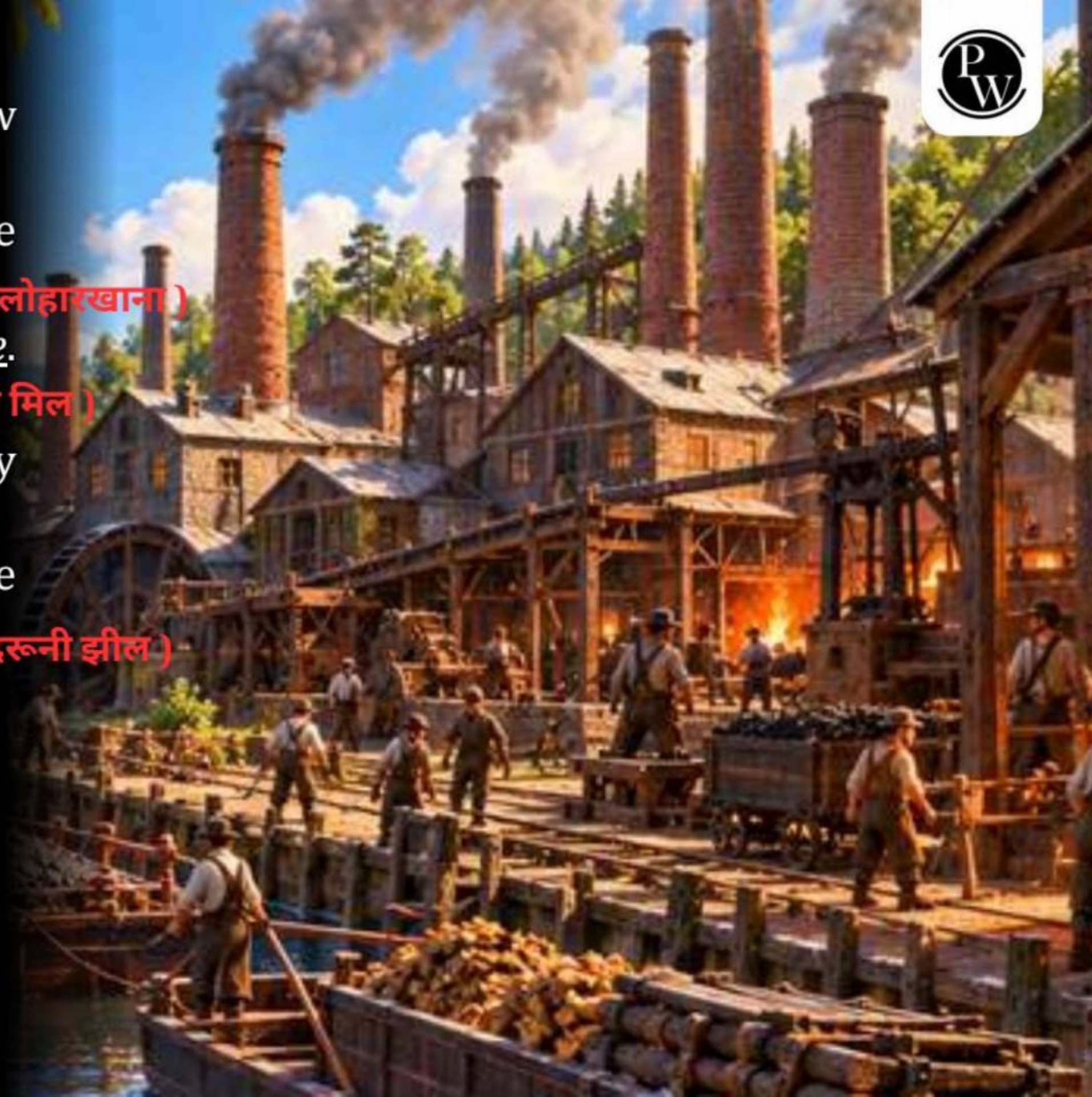
The Ramsjo Ironworks, which are now
(shut , बंद)
closed down, were, not so long ago, a large
(melting furnace , धातु गलाने की भट्टी) (smithy , लोहारखाना)
plant, with smelter, rolling mill, and forge.

(metal-shaping mill , लोहे को आकार देने की मिल)

In the summertime long lines of heavily

(cargo boats , मालवाहक नावें)
loaded barges and scows slid down the

(waterway , नहर) (interior lake , अंदरूनी झील)
canal, which led to a large inland lake,



and in the wintertime the roads near the
mill were black from all the coal dust

(**fell slowly** , धीरे-धीरे गिरा)
which sifted down from the big charcoal
(**large boxes** , बड़े बक्से)
crates.



During one of the long dark evenings just

(**head blacksmith** , मुख्य लोहार)
before Christmas, the master smith and

(**workshop** , लोहारखाना)
his helper sat in the dark forge near the

(**raw iron** , कच्चा लोहा)
furnace waiting for the pig iron, which

had been put in the fire, to be ready to

(**iron block** , निहाई)
put on the anvil.



Every now and then one of them got up
(**hot shining iron** , चमकता गर्म लोहा)
to *stir* the glowing mass with a long iron
bar, returning in a few moments,
(**covered in sweat** , पसीने से तर)
dripping with perspiration, though, as
was the custom, he wore nothing but a
long shirt and a pair of wooden shoes.

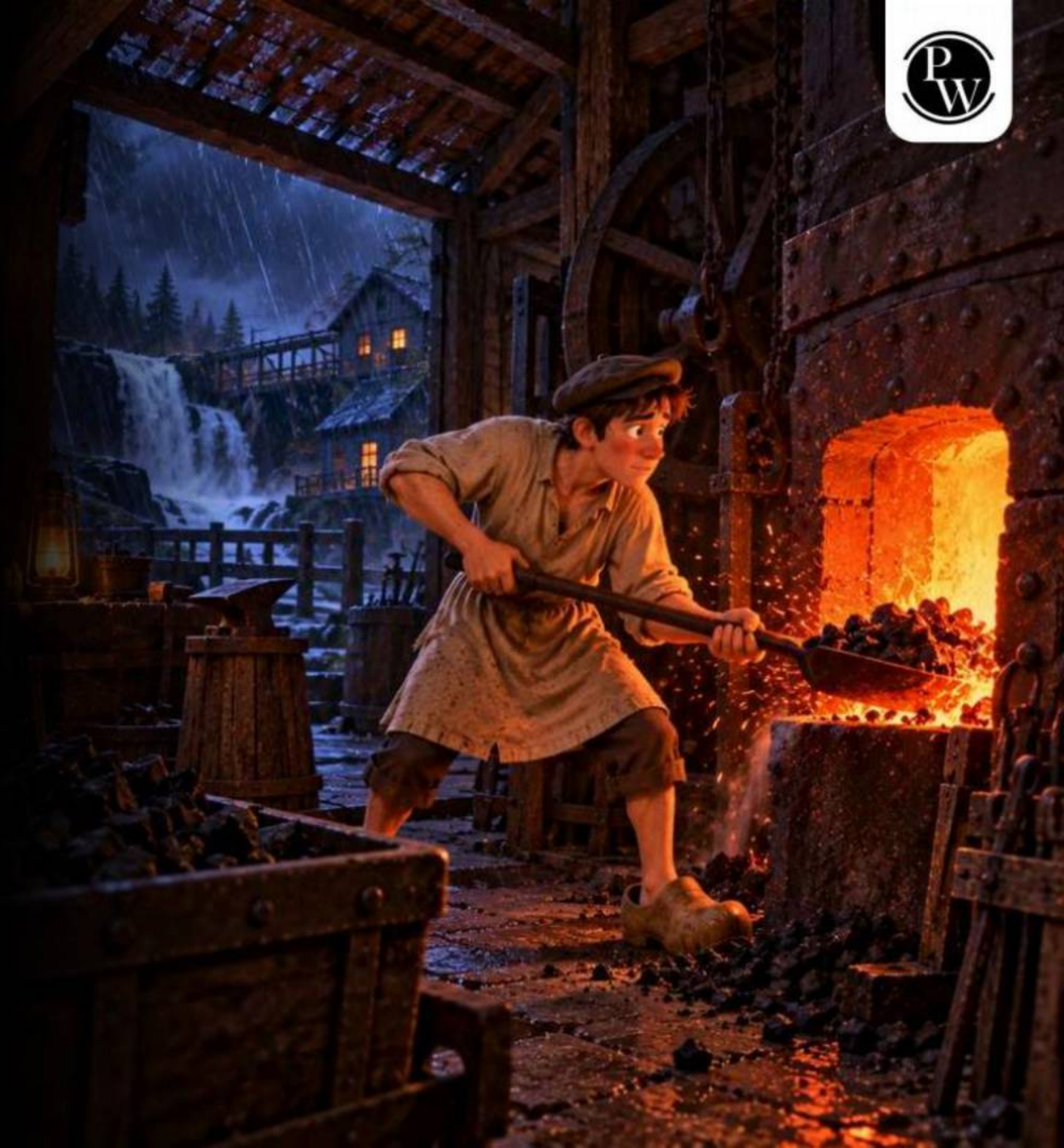


All the time there were many sounds to
(air pump , धौंकनी)
be heard in the forge. The big bellows
(made a deep sound , कराहने जैसी आवाज की)
groaned and the burning coal cracked.
(made sharp sounds , चटखने लगा)



(scooped , फावड़े से डाला)

The fire boy shovelled charcoal into the
(mouth , मुँह)
maw of the furnace with a great deal of
(rattling noise , खड़खड़ाहट)
clatter. Outside roared the waterfall, and
(made a loud sound , गरजा)
a sharp north wind whipped the rain
(struck , तेज़ी से मारा)
against the brick-tiled roof.



(reason , कारण)

It was probably on account of all this noise that the blacksmith did not notice that a man had opened the gate and entered the forge, until he stood close up to the furnace.



(**uncommon** , असामान्य)

Surely it was nothing unusual for poor

(**wanderers** , घुमक्कड़)

vagabonds without any better shelter for

(**smithy** , लोहारखाना)

the night to be attracted to the forge by

the glow of light which escaped through

(**blackened windows** , कालिख लगे शीशे)

the sooty panes, and to come in to warm

themselves in front of the fire.



(looked briefly , एक नज़र देखा)

The blacksmiths glanced only casually

(without interest , उदासीनता से)

and indifferently at the intruder.

(unwanted entrant , अनचाहा घुसपैठिया)



He looked the way people of his type usually did, with a long beard, dirty, (torn, फटेहाल) ragged, and with a bunch of rattraps (hanging loosely, लटकते हुए) dangling on his chest.



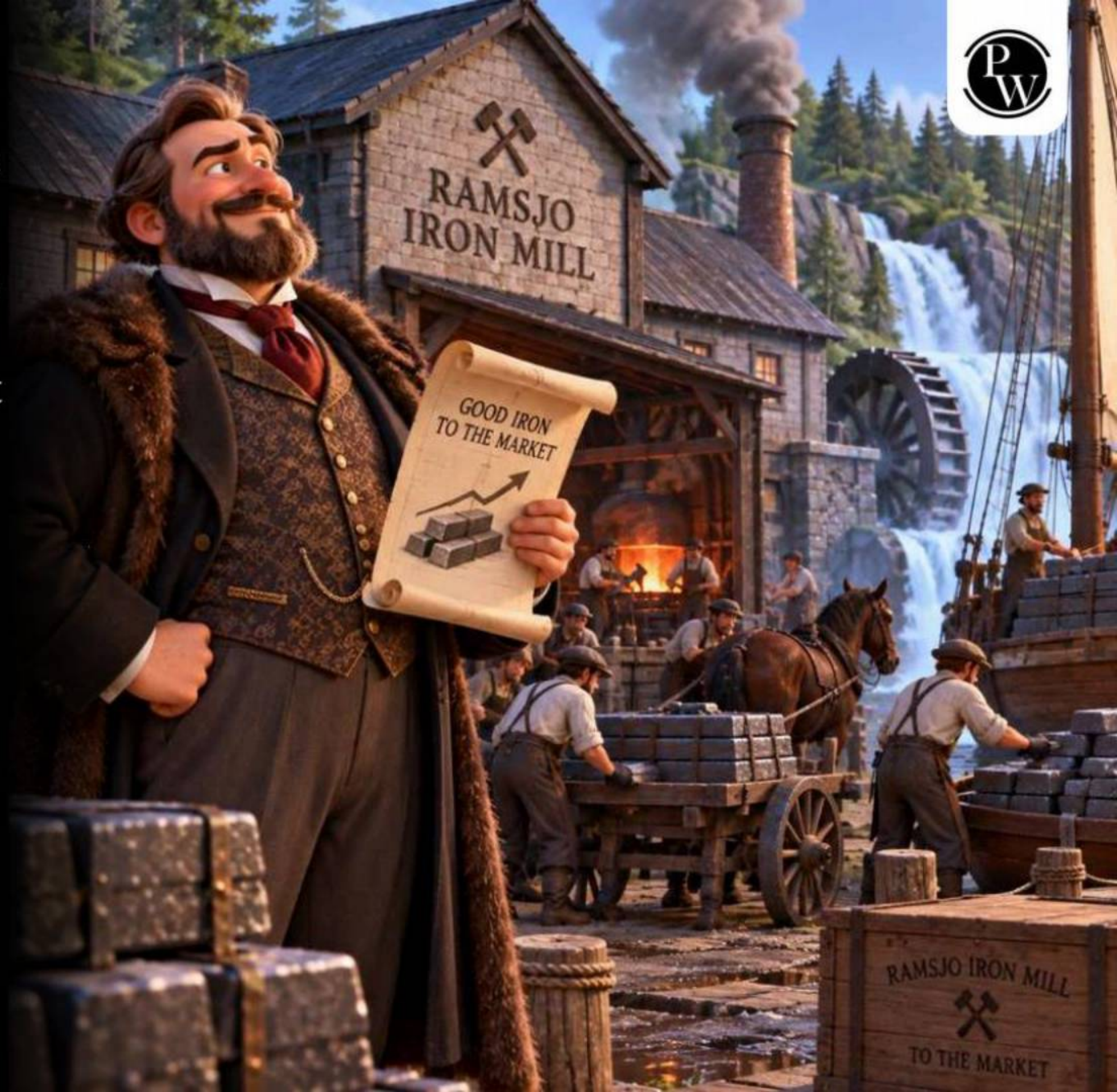
He asked permission to stay, and the
(moved his head , सिर हिलाया)
master blacksmith nodded a haughty
(proud permission , घमंडी स्वीकृति)
consent without honouring him with a
(respecting , सम्मान देना)
single word.



The tramp did not say anything, either.
He had not come there to talk but only to
warm himself and sleep.



In those days the Ramsjo iron mill was
(**important** , प्रमुख)
owned by a very prominent ironmaster,
(**aim** , महत्त्वाकांक्षा)
whose greatest ambition was to ship out
good iron to the market.



(**ensure** , सुनिश्चित करना)

He watched both night and day to see
that the work was done as well as
possible, and at this very moment he
came into the forge on one of his nightly
(**checking** , जाँच)
rounds of inspection.



Naturally the first thing he saw was the
(shabby person , फटेहाल व्यक्ति)
tall ragamuffin who had eased his way so
close to the furnace that steam rose from
his wet rags.



The ironmaster did not follow the example of the blacksmiths, who had
(**bothered** , कृपा की / ध्यान दिया)
hardly deigned to look at the stranger.

He walked close up to him, looked him
(**pulled off quickly** , झटके से उतारा)
over very carefully, then tore off his
slouch hat to get a better view of his
(**soft loose hat** , ढीली टोपी)
face.



“But of course it is you, Nils Olof!” he said. “How you do look!”

The man with the rattraps had never before seen the ironmaster at Ramsjö and did not even know what his name was.



(came to his mind , उसके मन में आया)

But it occurred to him that if the fine

gentleman thought he was an old

(known person , जान-पहचान वाला)

acquaintance, he might perhaps throw

him a couple of kronor. Therefore, he did

(tell the truth , भ्रम दूर करना)

not want to undeceive him all at once.

“Yes, God knows things have gone

(worse , बिगड़ना)

downhill with me”, he said.



“You should not have resigned from the regiment”, said the ironmaster. “That was the mistake. If only I had still been in the service at the time, it never would have happened. Well, now of course you will come home with me.”



(together , साथ) (large house , हवेली)

To go along up to the manor house and

(welcomed , स्वागत किया गया)

be received by the owner like an old

(companion , साथी)
regimental comrade — that, however,

did not please the tramp.



“No, I couldn’t think of it!” he said,
(**frightened** , घबराया हुआ)
looking quite alarmed. He thought of the
thirty kronor. To go up to the manor
house would be like throwing himself
(**willingly** , स्वेच्छा से)
voluntarily into the lion’s den. He only
wanted a chance to sleep here in the
(**leave secretly** , चुपके से निकल जाना)
forge and then sneak away as
(**unnoticed** , बिना ध्यान खींचे)
inconspicuously as possible.



The ironmaster assumed that he felt
(**ashamed** , शर्मिदा) (**very poor** , दयनीय)
embarrassed because of his miserable
clothing.

“Please don’t think that I have such a
fine home that you cannot show yourself
there”, He said... “Elizabeth is dead, as
you may already have heard.



(overseas , विदेश में)

My boys are abroad, and there is no one at home except my oldest daughter and myself. We were just saying that it was too bad we didn't have any company for Christmas. Now come along with me and help us make the Christmas food disappear a little faster."



But the stranger said no, and no, and again no, and the ironmaster saw that he (**yield** , **मान जाना**) must give in.

“It looks as though **Captain von Stahle** preferred to stay with you tonight, **Stjernstrom**”, he said to the master (**turned around** , **मुड़ गया**) blacksmith, and turned on his heel.



But he laughed to himself as he went away, and the blacksmith, who knew him, understood very well that he had
(final decision , अंतिम बात)
not said his last word.



It was not more than half an hour before
(**horse-drawn vehicle** , घोड़ा-गाड़ी)
they heard the sound of carriage wheels
outside the forge, and a new guest came
in, but this time it was not the
ironmaster. He had sent his daughter,
(**seemingly** , शायद / प्रतीत होता है)
apparently hoping that she would have
(**convincing** , मनाना)
better powers of persuasion than he
himself.



Servant

She entered, followed by a valet, carrying
(**warm coat** , फर वाला गर्म कोट)
on his arm a big fur coat. She was not at
(**simple** , सादा / विनम्र)
all pretty, but seemed modest and quite
shy. In the forge everything was just as it
had been earlier in the evening. The
(**trainee** , प्रशिक्षु)
master blacksmith and his apprentice
still sat on their bench, and iron and
(**shone** , चमक रहा था)
charcoal still glowed in the furnace.



(lay down fully , पूरा शरीर फैलाकर लेटना)

The stranger had stretched himself out on the floor and lay with a piece of pig iron under his head and his hat pulled down over his eyes. As soon as the young girl caught sight of him, she went up and lifted his hat. The man was evidently

(sleeping alertly , सतर्क होकर सोना)

used to sleeping with one eye open. He

(suddenly , अचानक)

jumped up abruptly and seemed to be

(scared , डरा हुआ)

quite frightened.



“My name is Edla Willmansson,” said the young girl. “My father came home and said that you wanted to sleep here in the forge tonight, and then I asked permission to come and bring you home to us. I am so sorry, Captain, that you are having such a hard time.”



She looked at him **(kindly , सहानुभूति से)** compassionately, with **(sad-looking eyes , उदास आँखें)** her heavy eyes, and then she noticed that the man was afraid. “Either he has stolen something or else he has escaped from, jail”, she thought, and added quickly, “You may be sure, Captain, that you will be allowed to leave us just as freely as you came. Only please stay with us over Christmas Eve.”



She said this in such a friendly manner
that the rattrap peddler must have felt
(**trust** , **भरोसा**)
confidence in her.

(**have come to mind** , **मन में आना**)
“It would never have occurred to me that
(**take trouble for me** , **मेरे लिए कष्ट करना**)
you would bother with me yourself,
miss,” he said. “I will come at once.”



He accepted the fur coat, which the valet handed him with a deep bow, threw it over his rags, and followed the young lady out to the carriage, without (giving, देना) (surprised , हैरान) granting the astonished blacksmiths so much as a glance.

But while he was riding up to the manor (bad feeling , अनहोनी की आशंका) house he had evil forebodings.



“Why the devil did I take that fellow’s money?” he thought. “Now I am sitting in the trap and will never get out of it.”



Key Notes

A poor vagabond

- A hapless victim of want and hunger
- Sells rattraps out of begged material to make both ends meet
- Resorts to begging and stealing for additional income



The vagabond's sombre thought

- The whole world's a big rattrap
- All comforts and joys are nothing but baits to trap
- Succumbing to temptation spells end of everything
- Vagabond enjoys dwelling on this thought during lonely plodding's



A generous host

- Seeks shelter in a small gray cottage by the roadside
- Owner, an old man without wife or children, accommodates him
- Feeds him porridge and treats kindly
- The two smoke and play cards together



The host confides in the vagabond

- Host formerly a crofter at ramsjö ironworks
- Now supported by a milch cow
- Earned thirty kronor in payment last month
- Shows the amount saved in a pouch hung on a nail near the window frame



Vagabond steals the money

- Next morning the guest thanks the old man, bids goodbye and goes his own way
- Host locks the house; goes to milk the COW
- Guest returns after half an hour
- Smashes the windowpane
- Steals the money and runs away



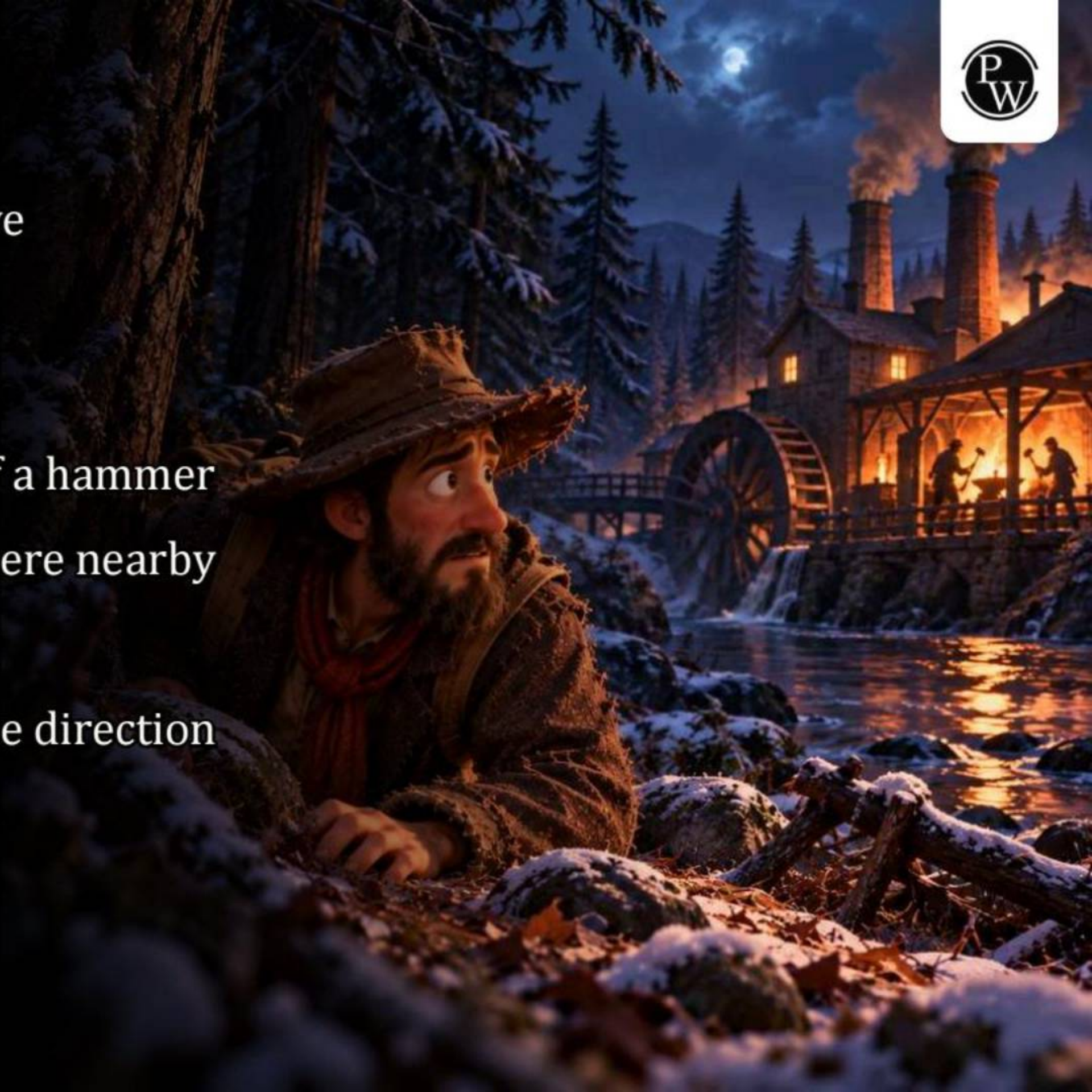
Lost in the forest

- Vagabond discards public highway to avoid getting caught
- Turns off the road into the woods
- Walks through mazes of forest paths
- Lands nowhere as the forest was big and confusing
- Dead tired; realises that he has been trapped
- Forest an impenetrable prison; escape impossible



A hope in the darkness

- Vagabond dejected and apprehensive
- Sees no way out
- Sinks to the ground in despair
- Suddenly hears regular thumping of a hammer
- Realises that an iron mill is somewhere nearby
- Gets another lease of life
- Gathers his strength and walks in the direction of the sound
- Reaches Ramsjo ironworks
- Work in full swing; very noisy place



Vagabond sneaks into the mill unnoticed

- Opens the gate and enters the forge
- Seeks permission from the master blacksmith to stay overnight
- Permission granted but coldly
- Lies down to sleep close to the furnace in order to warm himself



Ironmaster's nightly visit

- Owner of the mill particular about quality product
- Makes regular nightly rounds to monitor quality of work
- Presence of the vagabond catches his attention; looks at him very closely
- Mistakes him for captain nils olof, an old regimental comrade
- Hoping to get some money from the ironmaster, the vagabond doesn't deny his identity
- Ironmaster invites him to his manor house



Glossary



- **Resort to** : to turn to
- **Petty** : insignificant; trivial
- **Thievery** : stealing
- **Keep body and soul together** : to manage to keep existing, especially when one has very little money
- **Gleamed** : shone
- **Monotonous** : boring
- **Vagabond** : a wanderer; a person without a permanent home who moves from place to place
- **Plod** : trudge; to walk laboriously
- **Meditations** : deep thoughts
- **Baits** : traps

- **Unwonted** : unusual
- **Cherished** : held affection for something or someone
- **Dreary** : dull
- **Snare** : trap
- **Trudging** : walking tiredly
- **Supper** : the evening meal
- **Carved off** : cut a big piece from
- **Generous with his confidences** : he could easily share his secrets with anybody
- **Crofter** : a person in Scotland who rents or owns a small farm adjoining a house
- **Bossy** : (here) cow
- **Creamery** : factory producing dairy products
- **Kronor** : a unit of money in Sweden
- **Incredulous** : unbelievable

- **Nodding** : moving head to express agreement
- **Stuffed** : pushed quickly and carelessly
- **Thickets** : bushes
- **Peddler** : a person who sells things moving door to door
- **Impenetrable** : that cannot be entered, passed through or seen through
- **Descending** : coming down
- **Gloom** : sorrow
- **Despair** : disappointment
- **Summoned** : (here) gathered
- **Staggered** : walked unsteadily
- **Smelter** : an industrial plant for smelting
- **Rolling mill** : a factory that produces metal sheets
- **Forge** : a blacksmith's workshop

- **Barges and scows** : flat bottomed boats
- **Sifted** : separated
- **Crates** : big containers
- **Furnace** : chamber for intense heating by fire
- **Pig iron** : raw iron
- **Anvil** : a heavy block of iron or steel with a smooth, flat top on which metals are shaped by hammering
- **Perspiration** : sweat
- **Bellows** : device for driving air into fire
- **Shovelled** : threw in a rough or hasty way
- **Maw** : something that seems like a big mouth and swallows up things completely
- **Clatter** : aloud noise
- **Vagabonds** : wanderers

- **Dangling** : hanging or swinging freely
- **Intruder** : a one who enters a building, ground etc. Without permission
- **Haughty** : arrogant
- **Consent** : to agree or to allow
- **Tramp** : a person with no home or job who travels from place to place asking for food or money
- **Ragamuffin** : a shabbily clothed person
- **Deigned** : to think fit; considered worthy
- **Slouch hat** : hat with wide flexible brim
- **Undeceive** : to reveal the truth to (someone previously misled)
- **Regiment** : a military unit
- **Comrade** : a close friend one has worked with
- **Downhill** : on a decline

- **Manor** : large country house with lands
- **Sneak away** : go away secretly
- **Inconspicuously** : without being noticed
- **Assumed** : thought that it was true without
- **Persuasion** : knowing the truth
- **Valet** : a gentleman's personal servant
- **Apprentice** : a job trainee
- **To sleep with one eye open** : to have a light sleep
- **Abruptly** : suddenly
- **Compassionately** : sympathetically
- **Astonished** : surprised
- **Forebodings** : strong feelings that something unpleasant or dangerous is going to happen
- **Queer** : strange

- **Well groomed** : looking clean, neat and well dressed
- **Puckered** : wrinkled
- **Dissimulate** : to disguise or pretend
- **Splendour** : grandeur
- **Sheriff** : an officer to maintain law and order
- **Rind** : thick outer skin
- **Wretch** : an unhappy or unfortunate person
- **Interceded** : pleaded in favour of
- **Mumbled** : muttered
- **Parson** : priest
- **A tone stretch** : non-stop; in one go
- **Fare** : (here) food and drink that is offered as a meal

Summary



The story is about a poor wanderer who used to make his living by selling rattraps made out of begged material. He also took to petty stealing at times as selling rattraps alone was not enough to sustain him. When lonely, a somber thought often crossed the rattrap-seller's mind. He felt that all the comforts of life were nothing, but baits set to trap human beings. Thus, he found the world to be similar to a rattrap where men and women succumbed to temptations. One day, as he moved door to door selling his rattraps, he reached a small gray cottage and sought shelter from the owner who lived alone. This man had been a crofter at Ramsjo Ironworks. He was extremely kind to the peddler. He not only fed him porridge but the two also smoked together and played cards.

The crofter was so pleased to have a guest that he disclosed his source of income to this stranger. He showed him the thirty kronor which he had got after selling his cow's milk to the creamery and had kept in a pouch hung on a nail near the window frame. The next morning the rattrap seller took leave of his host but returned half an hour later, smashed the windowpane and stole the money that the crofter had shown him the previous evening. He took to the road into the woods to avoid getting caught. He walked quite long and got confused by the maze of forest paths. Dead-tired and hungry, he realized that he had fallen into a trap. Suddenly he heard the regular thumping of the hammer and realized that he was near some iron mill. He gathered strength and walked in the direction of the sound to finally reach the Ramsjö Ironworks. He sneaked into the mill and entered the forge.

He sought permission from the master blacksmith to stay for the night. The man agreed but rather coldly. Still, the peddler went close to the furnace to warm himself and lied down to sleep. The owner of this mill was a prominent ironmaster whose ambition was to ship out good iron. Hence, he would visit his workers regularly to inspect their work. He came to the mill that night as well. The rattrap seller's presence caught his attention, and he moved closer only to mistake him for his old regimental comrade Captain Nils Olof. Overwhelmed to meet his old acquaintance and saddened by his pitiable condition, the mill owner insisted the rattrap seller to accompany him to his manor house. The peddler did not reveal his true identity but refused to go with the ironmaster. After failing to convince the peddler to be his Christmas guest, the ironmaster left the mill.

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